AI ADVISOR & FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER · SENIOR IT TRANSFORMATION LEADER

# Filip Truyens



IT transformation leader with more than thirty years of experience in the private and public sectors. Today I advise organizations on AI. As a Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE), I also build together with the client. I do this under my own brand, Fender ICT · AI Advisory.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **33+** | **20** | **16** |
| years in IT, since April 1993 | employers and clients | certifications earned |

## Profile

I lead change in organizations that cannot afford mistakes: banks, insurers and government. I operate where technology, governance and risk meet. I have worked on projects in public cloud, in security, and today also in AI.

My background is program management. I translate strategic objectives into a multi-year roadmap, a budget and a team that knows what to do. Working as an FDE asks for more. I know the rules for security and privacy, and I speak the language of the IT department. I work out the business case and involve right from the start the people who will eventually use the solution.

Since late 2025 I have also been building solutions myself, with the help of AI. Preliminary work that used to take weeks now takes days. That leaves more time for consultation, eventually resulting in a better output.

## AI Advisory

| | |
|---|---|
| **Advice** | **AI advice**<br>Together with management, I look at where AI fits, where it does not and what it may do. I also check how it stays within the rules for security, privacy and audit. |
| **Co-creation** | **Forward Deployed Engineer**<br>A Forward Deployed Engineer does not work from a distance, but on site at the client. I build until the solution works and teach the team to use it. |
| **Experience** | **More than an engineer**<br>A good Forward Deployed Engineer combines strategy, budget, IT and security, change management and software. I built up that combination over thirty years, in many sectors. |
| **Approach** | **Rules and numbers first**<br>I start with the rules. What may AI do, under the regulations and within what the IT department allows? Then I look at the numbers. What does a task cost today, and what does AI deliver? |

**First client**

**Puur Reizen**

For a travel agency, I set up a shared AI workspace in ChatGPT Business together with the team. They now work consistently with their own tone of voice, house style and house rules.

## What I built with AI

2025 – 2026

Working software, built by me with the help of AI.

2025 – present

Own project

### Personal AI operating system

My own AI working environment, which I built and use every day.

- A growing library of skills, a memory system and AI agents I configure myself, for research, software and documentation.
- Works with Claude Code and with Codex, with the same skills on both sides.

**Technology:** Claude Code, Codex, Python, JavaScript, Markdown

Oct 2026 – present

Puur Reizen

### Customer portal and back office for Puur Reizen

Brings customers, trips, documents and invoices together in one place for a travel agency.

- Customers request a trip, see their own trips and invoices, and upload their travel documents themselves.
- The agency follows every trip by status, raises deposit and balance invoices, and sees requests, revenue and upcoming departures in reports.
- Status changes are proposals that a staff member confirms. Staff sign in with their Microsoft account.
- The data stays with the agency, with an open API, exports and webhooks. An AI application gets read-only access by default.

**Technology:** TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Microsoft Entra ID, REST API

Jul 2026

Smals

### Resource Capacity Planner

One shared, live view of which teams are stretched and which are not.

- Sets operational load against project work for **some forty technical teams**. It works at three levels, from team lead and division head to the Office of the CTO.
- From data model to live dashboards, running in production on Google Cloud.
- Replaced a set of manually maintained spreadsheets that nobody fully trusted.

**Technology:** Python, SQLite, Google Cloud Run

Apr 2026

Smals

### Automated NIS-2 and CyberFundamentals evidence factory

Compliance evidence for NIS-2 and the CCB's CyberFundamentals, collected automatically.

- Pulls configuration and control data from dozens of operational systems through their APIs and turns it into audit-ready reporting.
- **Weeks of manual work before every audit** became a repeatable run.
- I handled the source research, defined the data model, and did most of the engineering and the testing myself, all with the help of AI agents.

**Technology:** Python, SQLite, Google Cloud Run

## Sharing knowledge

2018 – 2026

Teaching, presenting and helping others get started.

| | |
|---|---|
| Oct 2026 | **Je hebt 2 jaar: AI for knowledge workers**<br>One-day hands-on training I designed and gave. Participants built their own working AI operating system around one recurring task, from context engineering to automation. On 23 October 2026. |
| Sep 2026 | **AI Team Day: GitHub Copilot Enterprise for team leads**<br>Smals · One-day hands-on training for the team leads of the Infrastructure Fabric & Operations Services division. I designed it and gave it together with a colleague. Every team lead built their own AI workspace around a recurring task of their choice. On 4 September 2026. |
| 2023 – 2026 | **Info sessions on public cloud and security**<br>Smals · For the member institutions of social security and the federal government, often to large audiences. |
| 2018 – 2021 | **IT reporting for franchisees**<br>Burger Brands Belgium · Regular presentations of IT achievements and the related costs at franchisee board meetings and regional meetings. |

## Expertise

What I know and use, grouped by domain.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Leadership and programs** | Program and portfolio management · steering committees and reporting to C-level executives · budgets, CAPEX and OPEX · FinOps · suppliers and public tenders · teams of up to 25 people · interim IT management |
| **Security and compliance** | ISO 27001/27002 · ISAE 3402 · NIS-2 · CCB CyberFundamentals · NIST CSF · C2M2 · OWASP SAMM and ASVS · COBIT · GDPR · post-quantum cryptography |
| **Cloud and infrastructure** | Azure · AWS · Google Cloud · landing zones · Entra ID · VMware · Citrix · Red Hat OpenShift · Windows Server and Active Directory · SAN and NAS |
| **AI and automation** | AI agents and agentic workflows · Claude Code · Codex · Claude Team · ChatGPT Business · LLM pilots · context engineering · Python · automated compliance evidence |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Methods** | PRINCE2 · ITIL v3 · DEMO · Scrum · PMBOK · BPMN · Cloud Adoption Framework |
| **Tools** | Jira · Confluence · Sciforma · ServiceNow · CA Clarity · HP PPM · Power BI · M365 |

## Languages

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dutch** | Native. |
| **French** | Bilingual. Four years of study in France (Angers and Paris) and the Diplôme Supérieur de Français des Affaires. |
| **English** | Full professional proficiency. Studied in Leeds and the daily working language in international programs. |

## Personality

| | |
|---|---|
| **Mar 2019** | **Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI): ISFJ**<br>MBTI profile, European edition (OPP) · Taken on 20 March 2019.<br>ISFJ stands for Introversion, Sensing, Feeling and Judging. In plain words, I prefer quiet focus and start from concrete facts. I keep an eye on the people who will work with the result. And I like a plan and commitments that are kept. |

References and recommendations available on request.

EXPERIENCE · 1993 – 2026

# Filip Truyens



More than thirty years in IT. I started in technical roles. Later I led programs in organizations where mistakes are expensive, such as banks, insurers and government. Today I advise on AI and, as a Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE), build together with the client. I do this under my own brand, Fender ICT · AI Advisory.

| **33+** | **20** | **27** |
|---|---|---|
| years in IT, since April 1993 | employers and clients | years running my own company |

## All roles at a glance

| PERIOD | DURATION | ORGANIZATION · ROLE |
|---|---|---|
| **TODAY · 2026 – PRESENT** | | |
| Oct 2026 – present | | **Fender ICT · AI Advisory**<br>Founder · AI Advisor & Forward Deployed Engineer |
| **PROGRAMS AND LEADERSHIP · 2010 – 2026** | | |
| Mar 2021 – Sep 2026 | 5 yrs 7 mos | **Smals**<br>Program Manager · Assistant IT Director |
| Nov 2018 – Feb 2021 | 2 yrs 4 mos | **Burger Brands Belgium**<br>Head of IT BeLux |
| May 2018 – Oct 2018 | 6 mos | **Belfius**<br>Project Manager Office 365 |
| Nov 2015 – Apr 2018 | 2 yrs 6 mos | **Getronics BeLux**<br>Project Manager Managed Services |
| Oct 2014 – Oct 2015 | 1 yr 1 mo | **Deutsche Bank Belgium**<br>Project Manager Application Services |
| Feb 2011 – Sep 2014 | 3 yrs 8 mos | **AXA Technology Services Belgium**<br>Program Manager · Project Manager |
| Jan 2010 – Jan 2011 | 1 yr 1 mo | **De Persgroep Publishing**<br>Team Lead · Project Manager · Infrastructure Architect |
| **INFRASTRUCTURE AND ARCHITECTURE · 1993 – 2009** | | |
| Oct 2008 – Dec 2009 | 1 yr 3 mos | **Eandis**<br>Infrastructure Architect |
| Jan 2005 – Sep 2008 | 3 yrs 9 mos | **Pioneer Europe**<br>Senior Systems Engineer |
| Sep 2004 – Dec 2004 | 4 mos | **Agfa HealthCare**<br>Systems Engineer, Integration Engineering |
| Sep 2002 – Aug 2004 | 2 yrs | **Belgian Post Group**<br>Senior Systems Engineer |

| PERIOD | DURATION | ORGANIZATION · ROLE |
|---|---|---|
| Mar 2001 – Aug 2002 | 1 yr 6 mos | **Merck Sharp & Dohme**<br>System Engineer, IS EMEA NT Computing |
| Dec 2000 – Feb 2001 | 3 mos | **Telenet**<br>System Engineer |
| Nov 2000 | 1 mo | **CGU Benelux**<br>System Engineer |
| Feb 2000 – Oct 2000 | 9 mos | **Distrirest Benelux**<br>System Engineer |
| Jan 2000 | 1 mo | **UUNET**<br>System Engineer |
| Mar 1998 – Dec 1999 | 1 yr 10 mos | **MSP bvba**<br>System Engineer |
| Mar 1996 – Feb 1998 | 2 yrs | **CW Lease Belgium**<br>NT System Administrator & AS/400 Operator |
| Aug 1995 – Nov 1995 | 4 mos | **MFS Communications**<br>Data Analyst |
| Apr 1993 – Jul 1995 | 2 yrs 4 mos | **Zuidnatie**<br>Novell System Administrator & Functional Analyst |

## Today

2026 – present

Full time in my own company, with advice on AI and co-creation as a Forward Deployed Engineer.

**Oct 2026 – present**

Schilde

Own company

### Fender ICT · AI Advisory

**Founder · AI Advisor & Forward Deployed Engineer**

My own company, founded in February 1999. It started as a management company. Today it is the base for AI Advisory, with advice on AI and co-creation as a Forward Deployed Engineer.

WHAT I AM WORKING ON

- First client: Puur Reizen. Set up a shared AI workspace in ChatGPT Business together with the team, as a Forward Deployed Engineer. It has several projects and useful shared skills.
- Since late 2025 I have been building my own AI working environment. It has a growing library of skills, a memory and AI agents that I configure myself. I use it every day for research, software and documentation.
- For my clients, analysis and documentation work that used to take **weeks** now takes **days**.

## Programs and leadership

2010 – 2026

Programs, projects and IT leadership in government, banking, insurance, IT services,

media and even retail.

**Mar 2021 – Sep 2026**
5 yrs 7 mos

Brussels

Public sector

## Smals

**Program Manager · Assistant IT Director**

The shared IT provider for Belgian social security and the federal government. I ran programs that touched the whole organization and its member institutions, in a heavily regulated environment.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Ran **three strategic programs at once**: public cloud, cybersecurity and emerging technologies, reporting to senior management through recurring steering committees.
- Turned regulation (NIS-2, CyberFundamentals, ISO 27001) and technical risk into priorities, budgets and roadmaps that management could decide on.
- In 2026, built **two working applications** with AI agents: a NIS-2 evidence factory and a capacity planner for some forty technical teams.

ROLES

### Program Manager Post-Quantum Cryptography

Sep 2025 – Sep 2026 · 1 yr 1 mo

- Made senior management aware of what quantum computing means for today's encryption.
- Drew up a post-quantum readiness roadmap with Smals Research and took part in the EU-funded workshops.
- Worked out a crypto-agility approach with Enterprise Architecture, moving toward a single view of all hardware and software components (a global unified bill of materials).
- Wrote a vision paper on lifecycle management to reduce technical debt across infrastructure, platforms and applications.

### Program Manager Public Cloud

Jun 2024 – Sep 2026 · 2 yrs 4 mos

- Set up the program: governance, roadmap, and the launch and follow-up of every project.
- Defined the public cloud strategy with C-level executives (Azure, AWS, Google Cloud).
- Brought procurement, internal security, finance, HR and the AI Competence Center together on public tenders through the EU framework contract OCRE-GÉANT, data sovereignty, FinOps, training and the first generative AI pilots.
- Coached technical project managers through studies, proofs of concept and pilots: landing zones, automation, governance and confidential computing.
- Helped set up the **Public Cloud Center of Excellence** for the public social security institutions (OISZ) and co-wrote its strategic principles.
- Worked with the federal public cloud task force on policies and technical policy packs, managed cloud providers and integrators, and ran info sessions for member institutions.

**Technology:** Azure, AWS, Google Cloud, Entra ID, PIM, FinOps, DevOps, CloudOps, CAF, CI/CD, confidential computing

### Program Manager Security

Jan 2023 – Sep 2026 · 3 yrs 9 mos

- Led a self-assessment of the security posture with all stakeholders across Smals.
- Built a multi-year program to close the gaps, weighed on cost, risk, priority and feasibility.
- Oversaw the rollout of new security services (SOC, SIEM, CSIRT, vulnerability management, threat intelligence) and products (EDR/XDR, pentesting, forensics, honeypots) for Smals and its members.
- Prepared Smals for NIS-2, with policies and procedures, in close contact with the CCB.
- In April 2026, built an automated evidence factory for NIS-2 and CyberFundamentals. It pulls configuration and control data from dozens of systems through their APIs and turns it into audit-ready reporting. **Weeks of manual work before every audit** became a repeatable run.

**Technology:** ISO 27001/2, NIS-2, CCB CyberFundamentals, NIST CSF, C2M2, OWASP SAMM, COBIT

### Project Portfolio Manager

Jul 2022 – Sep 2026 · 4 yrs 3 mos

- Co-wrote the infrastructure roadmap in line with Smals' strategy, then steered its execution.
- Helped prioritize the Infrastructure & Support portfolio and set up recurring reporting.
- Matched people and profiles to the expected workload, and helped improve project methodology and capacity management.
- In July 2026, built a Resource Capacity Planner: one live view of operational load against project work for **some forty technical teams**, at three levels (team lead, division head, Office of the CTO). From data model to dashboards, running in production on Google Cloud. The tool replaced spreadsheets nobody fully trusted.

**Technology:** Sciforma, Confluence, Jira, Google Cloud

### Transversal Project Manager

Mar 2021 – Jun 2023 · 2 yrs 4 mos

- Steered Smals' delivery and customer-facing teams toward one highly available, highly secure DevOps platform for several health and social care applications.
- Customers: RIZIV-INAMI (Recip-e, UHMEP, Vidis, SAMv2) and the Flemish Agency for Care and Health (Vitalink FHIR).
- Brought containers, CI/CD, privileged access management and secrets management together in one managed service.
- Owned it end to end: planning, communication, reporting to the customer and DPOs, technical implementation, support handover, cost calculation and invoicing.

**Technology:** Hyperconverged compute, VMware, Red Hat OpenShift, PostgreSQL, Ansible, CloudForms, Fluentd, Elasticsearch, AMQ, CyberArk PAM, CyberArk Conjur, Wallix PAM

Nov 2018 – Feb 2021
2 yrs 4 mos
Antwerp
Retail and franchising

## Burger Brands Belgium

**Head of IT BeLux**

Operator and franchisor of three quick-service brands in Belgium and Luxembourg: Quick, Burger King and GoFish. More than 110 restaurants, company-owned and franchised, across five sales channels. I led IT with a team of eight and sat on the leadership team.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- **€266K** saved in 2019 on an annual IT operating budget of €1.5M.
- **15%** higher franchisee satisfaction with IT, as measured in a survey.
- Outsourced first-line support to partner NCR in Belgrade.
- Organized the IT team of eight into three cells: operations, support and projects.
- Delivered IT for **15 to 20** Burger King and GoFish openings and Quick conversions a year, across till, kiosk, delivery, drive-thru and click & collect.
- Led the rollout of ordering kiosks, the optimization of the TALAN ERP system and the move from the loyalty app to click & collect.
- Ran public and private cloud (Azure, Office 365) locally and for the group, with peers in Luxembourg, France, Italy, Germany, Poland and Switzerland. Also handled IT requests from headquarters and from the Burger King group for Southern and Eastern Europe.
- Prepared the CAPEX and OPEX budgets, renegotiated supplier contracts, supported the DPO on GDPR and presented IT plans and their cost to franchisees and the board.

**Technology:** Azure, Office 365, Power BI, QlikView, Jira

May 2018 – Oct 2018
6 mos
Brussels
Banking and insurance

## Belfius

**Project Manager Office 365**

Belgian bank and insurer. I ran the risk and compliance stream of the strategic Office 365 program.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Got the National Bank of Belgium, Microsoft and internal functions (legal, security, non-financial risk, compliance, data protection, contracts and audit) aligned.
- Guided the program through the internal and regulatory advisory process on outsourcing, including the materiality assessment, Cloud Risk Assessment and DPIA.
- Laid out the path for deploying and managing Office 365 at Belfius.

Nov 2015 – Apr 2018
2 yrs 6 mos
Brussels
IT services

## Getronics BeLux

**Project Manager Managed Services**

IT service provider in Belgium and Luxembourg. I led infrastructure projects for managed services customers, with teams in Belgium and India.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Migrated **more than 500 Argenta branches** and several partners to a new DMZ, together with other suppliers. Any failure meant branch downtime. Delivered on time, to specification and within budget.
- Also moved an Argenta data center to Geleen (the Netherlands).

- Led an end-to-end insourcing for Argenx: infrastructure (vBlock, Office 365, SIP trunk, MPLS) and managed services (service desk, field services, monitoring).
- Led the LAN refresh with Cisco ISE for Record Bank, the WAN renewal for Bank Nagelmackers and a digital workspace for the World Steel Association.
- Headed the eight-month digital collaboration project for the City of Mechelen: Cisco telephony, contact center, Jabber and WebEx.
- Migrated Getronics' own monitoring from Smarts and NetIQ to ManageEngine, with a team at Getronics India.
- Guided internal process improvement with BPMN and helped the bid management team write proposals.

ROLES

### Information Security Manager

Nov 2016 – Oct 2017 · 1 yr

Alongside my project management role.

- **ISO 27001** and **ISAE 3402** (type I and II) certification for Getronics Belgium and Luxembourg, achieved **in ten months**.
- Set up the ISMS: business case and scope, risk assessment and statement of applicability, policies and procedures, internal and external audits, management reviews.
- Reported directly to the CEO, CFO, COO and CISO, and helped prepare for GDPR.

Oct 2014 – Oct 2015
1 yr 1 mo
Brussels
Banking

## Deutsche Bank Belgium

**Project Manager Application Services**

The Belgian arm of Deutsche Bank. I worked in the Online Banking domain.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Led the release and environment management streams in Vittoria, the European Online Banking program of **over €15M**, built on ACI, Backbase and Alfresco. Also acted as product owner (Scrum).
- Steered several streams in the Essential Maintenance program (€4.4M), largely to remediate group audit findings.
- Renewed the technical stack of Online Banking and the Deutsche Bank Portal in Belgium, together with IBM.
- Secured the integrity of all source code developed in Belgium, with full traceability from development to production. Followed the group SDLC standards and the recommendations of the banking regulators.

**Technology:** Subversion, Git, Maven, TeamCity, Nexus, uDeploy, Veracode, Apache, IIS, .NET

Feb 2011 – Sep 2014
3 yrs 8 mos
Brussels
Insurance

## AXA Technology Services Belgium

**Program Manager · Project Manager**

The AXA group's IT provider, North and East Europe region, with data centers in Germany. I led a group-wide program and several infrastructure projects there.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Led Nostradamus (RMPS2) for three years, a transformation program of **over 2,000 person-days** for AXA Group Solutions in France.

- Delivered a private cloud that became **the benchmark for all risk modelling applications** across the AXA group.
- Also led infrastructure projects for AXA Bank Belgium and for the PeopleSoft implementations of AXA Group Solutions and AXA Life Japan.

**Name change:** AXA Group Operations since 2019.

ROLES

### Program Manager Risk Management Platform Solutions (Nostradamus)

Oct 2011 – Sep 2014 · 3 yrs

- Wrote the business case with three scenarios (private, hybrid and public cloud). This positioned AXA Tech in direct competition with Amazon AWS and Microsoft Azure, on price, service and expertise.
- Built the private cloud from March 2012, with a self-service portal and hourly, usage-based charge-back. Delivered on **11 July 2012** after four months of building: on time, on budget and to specification.
- Onboarded the first customer, AXA Hedging Services, in September 2012, followed by other risk modelling customers.
- Defined the operating model (incident, problem, change), with technical and billing reporting, and negotiated new SLAs.
- Steered the move from IBM to HP blades and added the private cloud offer to the service catalog.
- Helped shape the group strategy for private and public cloud, defended the investments before the investment committee and promoted the platform to AXA entities worldwide.

**Technology:** VMware, Citrix PVS, Citrix XenApp, MS HPC, Tibco DataSynapse, BMC Atrium Orchestrator, HP blades, EMC SAN, NetApp NAS, Prophet, MoSes, Algo Risk, ReMetrica

### Project Manager AXA Bank Belgium

Apr 2013 – Jun 2014 · 1 yr 3 mos

- Within the regional Pillar savings program, led a data lifecycle management project (150 person-days): an archive service that automatically moves dormant data to low-cost storage.
- Infrastructure project manager for the confidential Bank of Tomorrow study (65 person-days): replacing some 50 mainframe applications with Sopra banking software (Thaler) on Linux and Oracle.
- Refreshed the disaster recovery NAS in the German data center (60 person-days).

### Project Manager AXA Corporate Programs

Feb 2011 – Dec 2012 · 1 yr 11 mos

- Led the infrastructure component of AXA Life Japan's PeopleSoft HR implementation (205 person-days, April 2011 to March 2012).
- Led the infrastructure component of AXA Group Solutions' PeopleSoft Finance (213 person-days, July 2011 to December 2012). Also managed the transition of some 50 file transfers for eight customers in Asia-Pacific.

Jan 2010 – Jan 2011
1 yr 1 mo
Brussels
Media

## De Persgroep Publishing

**Team Lead · Project Manager · Infrastructure Architect**

Publisher of newspapers and magazines in Belgium and the Netherlands. After the takeover of PCM Uitgevers, the Dutch newspapers' IT had to move away from outsourcer Getronics.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Led a team of **ten systems engineers** (Windows and Mac) and acted as interim IT Infrastructure Manager.
- Infrastructure architect for the business applications (publishing, marketing, advertising): target architecture, proofs of concept and capacity planning.
- Steered optimization and cost-saving tracks and improved incident, problem and change management.

**Name change:** DPG Media since 2019.

ROLES

### Project Manager PCM Uitgevers (De Persgroep Nederland)

Mar 2010 – Jan 2011 · 11 mos

- Ran the insourcing program of **over 2,000 person-days** for the exit from Getronics, for Algemeen Dagblad, Trouw and de Volkskrant.
- **1,800 workstations** and the Windows back end replaced in four months, with a team of 25.
- Migrated **2,000 mailboxes**, calendars and public folders in two months.
- Separated DNS and DHCP, consolidated Selligent, and was the point of contact between Dutch IT, Belgian IT and outsourcer Getronics.

**Technology:** Windows Server 2008, Windows 7, Active Directory, SCCM, VMware ESX, Citrix XenApp, Exchange, Quest Migration Manager

# Infrastructure and architecture

1993 – 2009

More than sixteen years of technical work, from system administration and networks to infrastructure architecture, often in international environments. Self-employed from February 1999.

Oct 2008 – Dec 2009
1 yr 3 mos
Energy

## Eandis

**Infrastructure Architect**

Electricity and gas distribution system operator in Flanders. I streamlined the development, validation and production environments.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Designed a new VMware VI3 platform for all pre-production environments and guided the transition.
- Drew up the strategy and roadmap for rolling out virtualization across the organization.
- Defined a standard ICT service offering for virtualization with outsourcing partner Telindus/HP and got it approved by the CAB.
- Built the full cost picture, raised the purchase orders and secured internal approval.

- Presented the new environment to developers, project managers, service managers and architects.

**Name change:** Merged with Infrax into Fluvius in 2018.

Jan 2005 – Sep 2008
3 yrs 9 mos
Antwerp
Electronics

## Pioneer Europe

**Senior Systems Engineer**

The European organization of the Japanese electronics maker, with its European data center in Antwerp.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Designed and built the IT for the new **European call center** in Antwerp: Citrix with thin clients at the front, clustered Windows and SQL Server servers behind.
- Designed a new Citrix platform (Presentation Server 4.5) for Pioneer and its European subsidiaries and migrated the existing MetaFrame XP farm.
- Upgraded the VMware environment (five ESX servers on blades with SAN), consolidated Windows and Linux servers and converted physical servers to virtual.
- Chose Altiris after comparing it with SMS, LANDesk and ZENworks, then built desktop management, software distribution and patch management for all European offices.
- Built endpoint security with McAfee ePolicy Orchestrator and Check Point Integrity, and set up quota management for the file servers.
- Tested Office Communications Server 2007 and web meeting tools in a separate environment, without touching the existing Active Directory.

ROLES

### Project Manager

Jan 2008 – Sep 2008 · 9 mos

- Functional and technical lead for the company-wide SharePoint 2007 implementation, using PRINCE2.
- Compared SharePoint with IBM Lotus Quickr, and SCOM with Nagios, NetIQ AppManager and GroundWork Monitor.

Sep 2004 – Dec 2004
4 mos
Ghent
Healthcare IT

## Agfa HealthCare

**Systems Engineer, Integration Engineering**

Supplier of imaging and software for hospitals.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Built a Windows Terminal Server load-test environment for radiology information systems used in hospitals worldwide: simulation scripts, load tests and monitoring with MOM 2005.
- Also load-tested the Mediweb web application and wrote up the results for marketing.

Sep 2002 – Aug 2004
2 yrs
Brussels
Postal services

## Belgian Post Group

**Senior Systems Engineer**

Belgium's postal company.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Helped build a Citrix MetaFrame XP farm on IBM blades for Georoute, a business-critical application.
- Extended NetIQ AppManager monitoring to the entire Windows server estate, and trained colleagues and operators to use it.
- Built a highly available project management solution on Project Server 2003, together with Microsoft's product team. Microsoft turned it into a customer case story.
- Automated patch detection and deployment on **300 servers** with PatchLink, under change management and SLAs.
- Introduced server virtualization with Virtual Server 2005, consolidated web servers and SQL Server databases, and hardened the web servers in the perimeter network.

**Name change:** bpost since 2010.

Mar 2001 – Aug 2002
1 yr 6 mos
Brussels
Pharma

## Merck Sharp & Dohme

**System Engineer, IS EMEA NT Computing**

The pharmaceutical group's European IT coordination center in Brussels.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Rolled out NetIQ AppManager on **220 servers** across EMEA, with policy-based setup and reporting.
- Installed 20 new servers in EMEA subsidiaries remotely and unattended, including data and printer migration, and reinstalled 60 domain controllers.
- Set up a system to review and align the security standards of the Windows NT servers.
- Designed time synchronization for all Windows servers and helped plan the migration to Windows 2000 with US colleagues.

Dec 2000 – Feb 2001
3 mos
Mechelen
Telecom

## Telenet

**System Engineer**

Cable and telecom operator in Flanders.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Ran the entire internal Windows and BackOffice environment with three colleagues, about **50 servers**.
- Designed and built the Windows 2000 Active Directory and merged the legacy domains into one AD domain.
- Set up a new file structure on a Compaq SAN with Windows 2000 clustering, and distributed software with SMS 2.0.

Nov 2000
1 mo
Brussels
Insurance

## CGU Benelux

**System Engineer**

Insurer. A short assignment.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Documented the entire network in a Lotus Notes knowledge base for IT support, alongside Windows NT administration and second-line support.

**Name change:** Merged into Winterthur-Europe Assurances in 2002, part of AXA Belgium since 2008.

Feb 2000 – Oct 2000
9 mos
Tubize
Logistics

## Distrirest Benelux

**System Engineer**

Logistics company building new offices and warehouses. I ran IT and moved it at the same time.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Moved all Windows and AS/400 systems to the new building and set up disaster recovery procedures.
- Rebuilt the Windows NT architecture: Token Ring to Ethernet migration, new DHCP, WINS and DNS, logon scripts, profiles and policies.
- Prepared the technical infrastructure for the new Logys warehouse software (Windows NT and Oracle).
- Introduced cloned desktop deployment, built an intranet for support and wrote procedures for ISO certification.

**Name change:** Acquired by the STEF group in 1998, now STEF.

Jan 2000
1 mo
Brussels
Internet and telecom

## UUNET

**System Engineer**

Internet service provider. A short assignment.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Developed a laptop cloning method, wrote standard installation procedures and supported users on Windows NT and Exchange.

**Name change:** Then part of MCI WorldCom, Verizon since 2006.

Mar 1998 – Dec 1999
1 yr 10 mos
Edegem
IT services

## MSP bvba

**System Engineer**

IBM Business Partner and Microsoft Solution Provider. First as an employee, then from February 1999 self-employed through my own company. Assignments from one day to several months at customer sites.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Got LeasePlan Belgium's entire IT ready for the year 2000. With an inventory and software distribution tool, some **10 servers and 350 workstations** were compliant on time and fully documented.
- Ran an unattended, scripted workstation migration from Windows 9x to NT 4.0 for Rabobank Belgium.

- Built a completely new network for the Belgian Transport Workers' Union (BTB), with an AS/400 as file, DHCP and DNS server for about 30 PCs.
- Built a knowledge base and helpdesk (McAfee Helpdesk) for the Algemene Centrale during its move to Windows NT.
- Installed Windows NT on AS/400 and ran IBM Network Station pilots for other IBM customers.

**Name change:** Acquired by Cegeka in 2008.

**Mar 1996 – Feb 1998**
2 yrs
Aartselaar
Car leasing

## CW Lease Belgium

**NT System Administrator & AS/400 Operator**

Company car leasing firm that was introducing many new systems at the time.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Ran the entire PC network: five Windows NT servers and about **a hundred PCs**, including the upgrade from NT 3.51 to NT 4.0.
- Migrated the last Novell servers to Windows NT and built fault tolerance for the business-critical servers.
- Set up SQL Server with replication to the AS/400 (Datamirror) and was the company's technical expert for it.
- Backed up the AS/400 operator for the three systems and connected the PCs through SNA Server.
- Handled mail and remote access, wrote ISO procedures, and provided first-line support and training.

**Name change:** Later ING Car Lease (2001), Alphabet since 2011.

**Aug 1995 – Nov 1995**
4 mos
Genval
Telecom

## MFS Communications

**Data Analyst**

Telecom company with offices across Europe.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Took part in the rollout of the Lawson Financials ERP across the European offices, handling the data analysis.

**Name change:** Acquired by WorldCom in 1996, Verizon since 2006.

**Apr 1993 – Jul 1995**
2 yrs 4 mos
Antwerp
Port logistics

## Zuidnatie

**Novell System Administrator & Functional Analyst**

Cargo handling company in the port of Antwerp. My first job in IT.

WHAT I BROUGHT

- Built a new network with an external software partner: two Novell servers and **25 OS/2 workstations**.
- Co-developed Dynahouse, new software for cargo handling and storage: translated user needs, tested and debugged, and organized acceptance.
- Single point of contact for all IT, including first-line support, procedures and training.

EDUCATION · 1981 – 2026

# Filip Truyens



I studied commercial sciences in Antwerp, Paris and Leeds, after a year of French in Angers. Since then I have kept learning, from Novell and Windows NT to virtualization, cloud and security. My most recent course was AIS Live, about AI, in October 2026.

| 16 | 36 | 3 |
|---|---|---|
| certifications earned | training courses | languages: Dutch, French and English |

## Studies

1981 – 1993

Commercial sciences in Antwerp, Paris and Leeds, after a year of French in Angers.

**1988 – 1993**
Antwerp

### Handelshogeschool Antwerpen

**Candidate in Commercial Sciences (Kandidaat in de Handelswetenschappen)**

- First year in 1988-1989, second year in 1992-1993 as an evening program, after the studies in Paris.
- Degree awarded on 17 September 1993.

**Name change:** Merged into Lessius Hogeschool in 2000. The commercial sciences program has been part of KU Leuven, Campus Antwerp, since 2013.

**1989 – 1992**
Paris

### École Commerciale de la Chambre de Commerce et d'Industrie de Paris (ECCIP)

**Études Supérieures de Gestion, Cycle Supérieur de Gestion, option Finance et Contrôle de Gestion**

- Three-year management program, majoring in finance and management control, completed with a final thesis.
- Diploma awarded on 8 July 1992.

**Name change:** Later Advancia and Novancia (2011), merged into ESCP Business School in 2017.

**Feb 1992 – Jun 1992**
Leeds (UK)

### Leeds Polytechnic

**Diploma in International Business**

- Exchange program from ECCIP: four months of European Finance and Accounting.
- Diploma awarded in July 1992.

**Name change:** Later Leeds Metropolitan University (1992), Leeds Beckett University since 2014.

1987 – 1988

Angers (France)

## Université Catholique de l'Ouest, Centre International d'Études Françaises (CIDEF)

**Diplôme de Langue et de Culture Françaises, niveau supérieur**

- A year of French after secondary school, at the Faculty of Letters and Human Sciences.
- Certificat de Langue et de Civilisation Françaises, intermediate level 2, with highest distinction (31 January 1988).
- Diplôme de Langue et de Culture Françaises, advanced level, with highest distinction (4 June 1988).

1981 – 1987

Wijnegem

## Annuntia-Instituut

**General secondary education, Modern Humanities, science track (Wetenschappelijke B)**

- Lower secondary at Sint-Jozefinstituut (1981 to 1984).
- Upper secondary at Annuntia-Instituut, science track (1984 to 1987).
- Upper secondary certificate and diploma of aptitude for higher education, 30 June 1987.

**Name change:** Sint-Jozefinstituut later became Annuntia-Instituut.

## Training and courses

1996 – 2026

Classroom training, online courses and multi-day events. Self-study and short briefings are not included.

| DATE | COURSE | PROVIDER | DURATION |
|---|---|---|---|
| Oct 2026 | AIS Live: Build Your AI OS (virtual event) | AI Automation Society, online | 2 days |
| 2024 | CISSP Cert Prep | ISC2 | 21 hours |
| 2021 | Essentials in People Skills (online) | Vlerick Business School | 12 hours |
| 2017 | CISM Online Review Course | ISACA | 17 hours |
| 2017 | Data Protection Introduction (GDPR) | Data Protection Institute | 2 days |
| 2015 | ServiceNow System Administration | ServiceNow, Amsterdam | 3 days |
| 2009 | Expert Class Enterprise IT Architecture (DEMO) | Universiteit Antwerpen Management School | 10 days |
| Oct 2008 | VMware Infrastructure 3: Install and Configure v3.5 | Distrilogie | 4 days |
| 2008 | PRINCE2 Foundation | Kluwer Opleidingen | 3 days |
| 2008 | ITIL v3 Foundation | Kluwer Opleidingen | 2 days |
| 2008 | PMI/PMBOK Project Management Methodology | Kluwer Opleidingen | 3 days |
| Nov 2007 | Implementing Microsoft Office SharePoint Server 2007 (MS 5061) | Guidance | 3 days |
| 2007 | Unlock the Power of VMware Infrastructure 3 | Xylos | 1 day |

| DATE | COURSE | PROVIDER | DURATION |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2005 | Unix and Linux Basics | Dolmen | 3 days |
| Jan 2005 | Citrix MetaFrame Secure Access Manager 2.2: Introduction (CTX-1300BW) | Citrix eLearning | 2 hours |
| Jul 2004 | Creating Reporting Solutions using SQL Server 2000 Reporting Services (MS 2030) | Guidance | 2 days |
| Apr 2004 | Deploying and Managing a Public Key Infrastructure (MS 2821) | Guidance | 3 days |
| Jul 2003 | Microsoft Visual Basic Scripting Edition and Windows Script Host Essentials (MS 2433) | U2U | 3 days |
| Apr 2003 | Implementing Microsoft Operations Manager 2000 | FleXcom Azlan | 1 day |
| Feb 2003 | Implementing Microsoft Windows 2000 Clustering | FleXcom Azlan | 3 days |
| 2003 | Updating Systems Engineer Skills from Windows 2000 to Windows Server 2003 | FleXcom Azlan | 2 days |
| Jun 2002 | Exchange 2000 Friday Session | Xylos | 1 day |
| Oct 2000 | Accelerated MCSE Training Program, Windows 2000 (six courses) | The Training Camp, Pennsylvania (US) | 14 days |
| Nov 1999 | Windows 2000 Active Directory Services | FleXcom | 4 days |
| May 1999 | Microsoft SQL Server 7.0 Upgrade and Migration | FleXcom | 3 days |
| Jun 1998 | IBM Network Station Update (release 3) | IBM, Hursley (UK) | 2 days |
| Feb 1998 | Coaching on Effective Presentations | IBM, La Hulpe | 1 day |
| Feb 1998 | IBM Network Station Fundamentals, Advanced NT and Advanced AS/400 | IBM, Hursley (UK) | 5 days |
| Nov 1997 | Microsoft SQL Server 6.5 Tuning and Optimization | FleXcom | 3 days |
| Aug 1997 | Advanced Datamirror Training | CW Lease Belgium | 2 days |
| Mar 1997 | Microsoft SQL Server 6.5 Administration | FleXcom | 4 days |
| Nov 1996 | Microsoft Windows NT 4.0 Update | Akam Education | 1 day |
| Nov 1996 | Supporting Microsoft Windows NT Server 3.51 | Akam Education, Wilrijk | 4 days |
| Apr 1996 | AS/400 System Operations Workshop | IBM, La Hulpe | 3 days |
| Apr 1996 | AS/400 Introduction | IBM, La Hulpe | 1 day |
| Mar 1996 | Datacommunication and Networking | Elcker-Ik, Antwerp | evening course |

## Certifications

1988 – 2015

From my first Microsoft exam in 1998 to ServiceNow in 2015, plus my language

diplomas.

### Management and governance

| | |
|---|---|
| Apr 2015 | **ServiceNow Certified System Administrator**<br>ServiceNow · Issued on 1 April 2015, certification 01003566. |
| Dec 2009 | **DEMO Professional (Design & Engineering Methodology for Organizations)**<br>DEMO Knowledge Centre, through the Universiteit Antwerpen Management School · Exam on 17 December 2009, diploma issued in Delft on 23 January 2010. |
| Apr 2009 | **ITIL v3 Foundation**<br>EXIN · Exam on 28 April 2009, certificate dated 6 May 2009. |
| May 2008 | **PRINCE2 Foundation**<br>APM Group · Exam on 28 May 2008, certificate 00033625-01-Q8R3. |

### Infrastructure and virtualization

| | |
|---|---|
| Jul 2009 | **Microsoft Certified IT Professional (MCITP): Server Administrator**<br>Microsoft · Windows Server 2008. Upgrade exam 70-649 on 30 July 2009. |
| Jan 2009 | **VMware Certified Professional (VCP) on VI3**<br>VMware · Awarded on 26 January 2009, VCP number 35048. |
| Feb 2008 | **Microsoft Certified Technology Specialist (MCTS): Windows Vista, Configuration**<br>Microsoft · Exam 70-620 on 22 February 2008. |
| Mar 2005 | **Citrix Certified Administrator (CCA) for MetaFrame XP Presentation Server**<br>Citrix · Awarded on 1 March 2005. |
| Jan 2005 | **Citrix Certified Administrator (CCA)**<br>Citrix · Awarded on 4 January 2005. |
| Mar 2004 | **Microsoft Certified Systems Engineer (MCSE): Windows Server 2003**<br>Microsoft · Among the first 5,000 worldwide. Exams 70-292 (21 January 2004) and 70-296 (25 March 2004). |
| Jan 2004 | **Microsoft Certified Systems Administrator (MCSA): Windows Server 2003**<br>Microsoft · Exam 70-292 on 21 January 2004. |
| Mar 2003 | **Citrix Certified Administrator (CCA) for MetaFrame XP for Windows**<br>Citrix · MetaFrame XP 1.0 for Windows 2000 Server exam on 17 March 2003. |
| Nov 2001 | **Microsoft Certified Systems Engineer (MCSE): Windows 2000**<br>Microsoft · Seven exams between October 2000 and 26 November 2001: 70-210, 70-215, 70-217, 70-219, 70-216, 70-244 and 70-222. |
| Jun 1998 | **Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP)**<br>Microsoft · First exam, Networking Essentials, on 19 June 1998. |

## Languages

| | |
|---|---|
| **Sep 1988** | **Diplôme Supérieur de Français des Affaires**<br>Paris Chamber of Commerce and Industry · Exam for non-native speakers, awarded on 1 September 1988. |
| **Jan 1988** | **Diplôme de Langue Française**<br>Alliance Française, Paris · Awarded on 30 January 1988. |